C-C-285B
January 26, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. C-C-285A
February 14, 1966

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHEESE, GRATED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for the preparation and packaging of grated cheese for use by agencies of the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification. Grated cheese covered by this specification shall be of the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I	-	Parmesan (Reggiano)
Type II	-	Romano
Type III	-	Blend of types I and II
Class 1	-	Commercial blend
Class 2	-	Specified blend
Type IV	-	Pasteurized process American cheese food

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping Fiberboard
PPP-C-55	-	Cans, Composite, for Dry Products
PPP-I-350	-	Individual Servings of Subsistence, Packaging and Packing of

FSC 8910

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Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1162 - Sanitary Standards for Cheese and Cheese Products Plants

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procureing activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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Laws and Regulations:

U. S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

Standards of Identity for Cheeses and Cheese Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U. S. Department of Agriculture

Brucellosis Eradication - Recommended Uniform Methods and Rules,
Agricultural Research Service
US Department of Agriculture
Bulletin ARS 91-79

US Standard for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the US Department of Agriculture, Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, Washington, DC 20250.)

General Specifications for Dairy Plants Approved
for USDA Inspection and Grading Service

Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service

U. S. Standards for Grades of Bulk American Cheese for Manufacturing
U. S. Standards for Grades of Nonfat Dry Milk (Spray Process)
U. S. Standards for Dry Whey
U. S. Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese
U. S. Standards for Grades of Colby Cheese

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Dairy Division, AMS, US Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the
Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Post Office Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Milk. The raw milk used in the preparation of this product shall comply with all the quality requirements specified in the General Specifications for Dairy Plants Approved for USDA Inspection and Grading Service for the manufacture of cheese. The milk shall be drawn from cows in herds accredited as tuberculosis-free and certified brucellosis-free by the US Department of Agriculture, or herds that have passed an annual tuberculosis test and meet USDA requirements for an individually certified herd, or from cows in herds located in:

(1) A Modified Accredited Tuberculosis Area; and
(2) Either (a) A Certified Brucellosis Area; or
(b) Modified Certified Brucellosis Area; or

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(3) An area in the process of being certified or accredited by the USDA in accordance with USDA Agricultural Research Service Bulletin 91-79. The milk shall be practically free from colostrum, fresh, wholesome, and normal in appearance and odor and shall be subject to inspection by the procuring agency or duly authorized representative. Types I and IV products shall be made from cow's milk only. Type II product may be prepared from cow's, goat's or sheep's milk or a blend of these milks. Such milks shall be drawn from healthy animals meeting the health requirements specified above. Pasteurized or unpasteurized milk may be used (see 3.1.2.3.1.1).

3.1.2 Cheese and cheese food. The cheese used in the preparation of types I, II, and III, and the cheese food used in the preparation of type IV shall meet the requirements as defined in the Standards of Identity for Cheeses and Cheese Products of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and the following additional requirements:

3.1.2.1 Type I, Parmesan (Reggiano). Natural Parmesan (Reggiano) cheese possessing a sweet, mellow, nut-like taste shall be selected for grating. If the cheese is aged more than one and one-half to two years, it may acquire a mildly piquant flavor, which shall be acceptable.

3.1.2.2 Type II, Romano. Natural Romano cheese possessing a characteristic piquant, sharp, fatty acid flavor and aroma shall be selected for grating.

3.1.2.3 Type IV, pasteurized process American cheese food.

3.1.2.3.1 Natural cheeses (cheddar, washed curd, colby and granular for processing). Pasteurized process American cheese food shall be made from Cheddar cheese, washed curd cheese, colby cheese or granular cheese, or any blend of two or more of these varieties. The interpretation of the flavor requirements (descriptive terms) for grades of natural cheddar cheese or optional varieties which may be used separately or in a blend shall be as described in the United States Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese, U.S. Standards for Grades of Colby Cheese, or U.S. Standards for Grade of Bulk American Cheese for Manufacturing. The cheese(s) shall conform to the flavor requirements for grade B or better or to the U.S. Standard Grade or better, respectively.

3.1.2.3.1.1 All cheeses shall be made from pasteurized milk, or held for not less than 60 days at a temperature of not less than 35° F, (2° C), before being grated.

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3.1.2.3.2 Optional dairy ingredients. When nonfat dry milk and dried whey are used in the manufacture of pasteurized process American cheese food, they shall conform to the requirements of the U.S. Extra Grade at time of use, as defined in the applicable U.S. Standards for Grades.

3.1.2.3.3 Emulsifying and acidifying agents. Emulsifying agents and acidifying agents, if used, shall be of the types specified in the Definitions and Standards of Identity of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. The weight of the solids of the emulsifying agent(s) used shall not exceed 3 percent of the weight of the finished product. The quantity of the acidifying agent shall be such that the pH of the finished product is not below 5.0.

3.1.2 3.4 Salt. Salt shall be white, refined, sodium chloride of food grade quality, free from extraneous material.

3.1.2.3.5 Coloring. Coloring, if used, shall be annatto or any other cheese or butter color certified by the U. S. Food & Drug Administration.

3.2 Processing.

3.2.1 Types I and II (see 3.1.2.1 and 3.1.2.2). Prior to grating, the cheese shall be properly cleaned and be free from all surface defects which are unwholesome or which will detract from the quality of the finished product. The cheese shall not be adulterated by the addition of any other ingredients. The cheese shall be grated or pluverized into uniform, fine granules or particle size in accordance with good commercial practice. The product shall be dehydrated in a sanitary drying chamber to meet the moisture requirements of table I.

3.2.2 Type III - Blend of types I and II. Type III cheese shall be processed as specified in 3.2.1 and blended to meet the requirements of 3.2.2.1 or 3.2.2.2, as applicable.

3.2.2.1 Class 1. Class 1 product shall be a blend of types I and II in proportions normally used in high quality commercial preparations (see 6.2).

3.2.2.2 Class 2. Class 2 product shall be a blend of types I and II, each being present at a level of not less than 25 percent by weight of the finished product to give the predominant blend flavor expected (see 6.1 and 6.2).

3.2.3 Type IV (see 3.1.2.3). The cheese used in the preparation of type IV shall be properly cleaned and shall be free from all surface defects which are unwholesome or which will detract from the quality of the finished product. Particle or granule size shall be as described in 3.2.1.

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3.3 Finished (grated) product.

3.3.1 Parmesan (reggiano). Type I product shall possess a characteristic full bodied, mild, slightly piquant, nutty parmesan cheese taste and aroma, free from musty, oxidized (cardboard), tallowy, soapy, or unclean flavors. The product shall have a uniform light cream to light natural-straw color. The particles shall be free flowing and free from lumps except those that break-up readily with slight finger pressure.

3.3.2 Romano. Type II product shall possess a characteristic sharp, piquant, pleasantly tart romano cheese taste and aroma free from musty, oxidized (cardboard), tallowy, soapy, or unclean flavors. The product shall have a uniform light cream to light natural-straw color. The particles shall be free flowing and free from lumps except those that break-up readily with slight finger pressure.

3.3.3 Blend of parmesan and romano. Type III product shall possess a typical taste and aroma which is contributed by the types I and II cheeses in the blend. The blend shall be free from musty, oxidized (cardboard), tallowy, soapy, or unclean flavors. The color shall be uniform and representative of the cheeses used. The particles shall be free flowing and free from lumps except those that break-up readily with slight finger pressure.

3.3.4 Pasteurized process American cheese food. Type IV shall possess a pleasing characteristic cheddar cheese taste and aroma and shall not have discernible more than a slight degree of acid, bitter, whey, weed or other commonly observed off-flavors listed in the U.S. Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese.

3.4 Analytical requirements. The finished product shall comply with analytical requirements of table I.

TABLE I. Analytical requirements

	Type I	Type II	Type III	Type IV
	Percent	Percent	Percent	Percent
Moisture (within the range)	13.0 to 17.0	13.0 to 17.0	13.0 to 17.0	16.0 maximum

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TABLE I. Analytical requirements (cont'd)

	Type I	Type II	Type III	Type IV
	Percent	Percent	Percent	Percent
Milkfat (F.D.B.) 1/ 2/ (not less than)	32.0	38.0	32.0	Milkfat by weight 23.0 or more
Salt (not more than)	6.9	6.9	6.9	5.0

1/ Fat on the dry basis.

2/ Tolerance for fat values shall be in accordance with those specified in the FDA Standards of Identity for Grated Cheese.

3.5 Plant qualification. The product shall originate, be processed, handled, packaged and stored in plants which are approved under the USDA General Specifications for Dairy Plants Approved for USDA Inspection and Grading Service, and listed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture in the document titled Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service, and approved for the finished product described in this specification, or in plants meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-1162.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Pre-acceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection). The product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.5.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of the product for quality and condition is performed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. (For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for Military agencies see 4.3.6.2.)

4.3.2 USDA Certificate of Quality and Inspection. When specified by the procuring agency (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish a U.S. Department of Agriculture inspection or grading certificate evidencing quality, quantity, and condition, as outlined in procurement documents. (See 6.2 for small lot orders.)

4.3.3 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.3.4 Component and material inspection. Component and materials shall be inspected in accordance with 4.1 and all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification, or applicable purchase document.

4.3.4.1 Establishment sources. Inspection shall be made to determine that all dairy product shipments received by the supplier have been processed, packaged, and shipped by establishments approved as military sources of supply as listed in the Directory of Sanitarily Approved Food Establishments for Armed Forces Procurement or from plants listed in the document entitled, "Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service". Nonconformance to the above requirement shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of finished product made therefrom, as applicable.

4.3.4.2 Establishment source for military procurement. Inspection shall be made to determine that the cheeses are from approved military sources of supply. Cheeses not originating from approved sources shall be considered an unacceptable component and use of such shall be cause for rejection of involved quantity of finished product.

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4.3.4.3 Cheese ingredient. Acceptance of the cheese ingredient shall be based on the examination of one or more cheeses from each vat for compliance with the applicable requirements of 3.1.2.1, 3.1.2.2 or 3.1.2.3. Records of the cheese meeting the flavor and age requirements for each day's processing operation shall be kept and be available for review by the Government inspector and may be accepted as evidence of compliance with 3.1.2.

4.3.4.4 Type IV - other ingredients. Acceptance of ingredients such as: emulsifying agents, acidifying agents, salt, coloring and optional dairy ingredients shall be based on the examination of the labels, invoices, and similar documents for compliance with the requirements of 3.1.2.3.2, 3.1.2.3.3, 3.1.2.3.4, or 3.1.2.3.5. This examination shall be made on each new lot of the component received and not less than once during each contract. A statement of compliance shall be provided by the contractor that the ingredients used conform to the applicable requirements.

4.3.5 In-process examination.

4.3.5.1 Equipment, procedures, controls, and formulation. Examination shall be performed during processing of the cheese to determine compliance with 3.2. Noncompliance with the requirements of 3.2, as determined by examination of records or actual examination shall be cause for rejection of the involved finished product.

4.3.6 Finished product inspection.

4.3.6.1 Civil agencies.

4.3.6.1.1 Lot size. An inspection lot shall be the number of primary containers of one type and class product to be inspected at one place at one time. More than one production code may be included in the lot if the number of cases from each code represented in the lot is known and the production dates are all within thirty days of one another. The acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be expressed in defects per hundred units.

4.3.6.1.2 Examination of the net weight and product characteristics. Examination of the net weight and product characteristics shall be in accordance with the following procedure: The appropriate minimum sample size designated in table II shall be formed by drawing one sample unit per shipping case selected proportionately from the production codes represented in the inspection lot. The acceptance (Ac) and rejection (Re) numbers are given in table II at the intersection of the sample size(s) row and the appropriate AQL column. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables IV and V.

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TABLE II. Single sampling plan

Number of primary containers in the inspection lot	Minimum sampling size	AQL (Net weight table IV) Total		Minimum sampling size	AQL (Product characteristics table V) Major		Total	
		Ac	Re		Ac	Re	Ac	Re
1 - 96	9	0	1	3	*	*	0	1
97 - 360	9	0	1	6	*	*	1	2
361- 1200	29	2	3	13	0	1	2	3
Over 1200	29	2	3	29	1	2	4	5

* Lots with one or more defect shall be rejected.

4.3.6.2 Military agencies.

4.3.6.2.1 Examination of the end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables IV and V and 4.3.6.2.1.1 through 4.3.6.2.1.5. The examination criteria for the above referenced tables shall be as shown in table III.

TABLE III. End item examination criteria

Table	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	AQL's Defects per hundred units	
				Major	Total
IV	1 filled and sealed container	Containers	S-3	-	2.5
V	1 filled and sealed container	Containers	S-2	1.5	6.5

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TABLE IV. Examination for net weight 1/ 2/
(For civil and military agencies)

Defect No.	Type container	Percent under specified weight
Minor		
201	50 pounds to 100 pounds (22.7 to 45.4 kg) net weight	0.5 or more
202	20 pounds to 49 pounds (9.1 to 22.2 kg) net weight	1.0 or more
203	Over 5 pounds to 20 pounds (2.3 kg to 9.1 kg) net weight	1.5 or more
204	Over 1 pound to 5 pounds (.45 to 2.3 kg) net weight	1.75 or more
205	1 pound (.45 kg) net weight	2.0 or more
206	Under 1 pound (.45 kg) net weight 3/	5.0 or more

1/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate lot net weight is less than specified net weight.

2/

For Defect No.	Report weight to nearest
201	1 pound or kg
202	1/2 pound or gram
203 and 204	1 ounce or gram
205	1/4 ounce or gram
206	0.1 gram

3/ For 5 gram pouches, the individual weight limitation shall be 10.0 percent or more under specified weight.

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TABLE V. Examination for product characteristics 1/ 2/
(For civil and military agencies)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Type or class not as specified
		Body and texture:
	201	(a) Optional test to be used to confirm visual observation. More than 20 particles in one level tablespoon not passing through standard number 14 screen (1.41 millimeter aperture after 30 seconds vibration)
	202	(b) Lumps that do not break under slight pressure (c) Particles not free flowing
		Flavor:
102		(a) Objectionable taste or odor (i.e., musty, oxidized (cardboard), tallowy, or soapy)
103		(b) Lacks characteristic flavor
104		(c) Not representative of blend
		Color:
	203	(a) Other than light cream to light natural-straw color (type I, II or III) (b) Other than medium yellow-orange (type IV) (c) Color not uniform

1/ One tablespoon of cheese shall be drawn from each sample unit selected for examination. Presence of foreign materials shall be basis for rejection of the entire lot.

2/ See 3.3.

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4.3.6.2.1.1 Examination of can labeling. Examination of can labeling shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of MIL-L-1497.

4.3.6.2.1.2 Examination of packaging. Examination for level B packaging of 3 ounce (85 g) and 1 pound (.45 kg) containers shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of PPP-C-55. In addition the following defect shall be included in the table of examination: Major: Interior liner missing or not as specified. For level C packaging examination shall be in accordance with the aforegoing specification except that only the defects for marking and interior liner shall apply.

4.3.6.2.1.3 Examination of case liner. Examination of waterproofed case liner shall be in accordance with examination criteria of MIL-L-10547.

4.3.6.2.1.4 Examination of shipping container. Examination of the filled and closed shipping containers for levels A and B pack shall be in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition the following defects shall be included in table of examination: Major: Marking missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Arrangement not as specified; (2) Round wire strapping used. For level C pack, examination shall be in accordance with the aforegoing specification except only the defects for marking shall apply.

4.3.6.2.1.5 Examination of 5-gram pouch and packing. When packaging and packing are required to be in accordance with PPP-I-350, examination shall be in accordance with the applicable examination criteria (except for net weight) contained in PPP-I-350.

4.4 Sampling procedure and acceptance criteria for testing the finished product. The finished product shall be tested for compliance with analytical requirements of table I. Procedures for testing shall be in accordance with 4.5. Test requirements shall be lot average requirements. The sample for testing 3 ounce (85 g) or larger containers shall be an 8 ounce (227 g) composite derived from the number of primary containers indicated by inspection level S-2 or from a sufficient number of 5 gram pouches to make up an 8 ounce (227 g) sample. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Noncompliance with one or more analytical requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5 Tests. Test procedures and controls which differ from those specified herein may be used by the contractor if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government inspection activity determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance, the contractor will use the test procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the test methods specified herein will govern.

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4.5.1 Chemical analyses. Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter - Dairy Products, Section - Cheese:

Test	Method
Milkfat	Fat
Moisture	Moisture - Method I
Salt	Total chlorides

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level B. The grated cheese shall be packaged in cans or pouches as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1.1 Cans. Three ounces (85 g) or one pound (.45 kg) as specified (see 6.2), of the type of grated cheese specified shall be packaged in a shaker-top, fiber can complying with type I, II or III, class 1, shape A, style 5, of PPP-C-55. Each container shall be provided with an interior greaseproof lining. The following minus tolerances for net weight will be allowed in any individual container, provided the average net weight of the containers, inspected in accordance with table IV is not less than the net weight specified above: 5 percent for 3 ounce (85 g) containers; 2 percent for 1 pound (.45 kg) containers.

5.1.1.2 Pouches. Five grams of the type of grated cheese specified shall be packaged in pouches in accordance with the requirements of PPP-I-350 for mustard.

5.1.2 Level C. The grated cheese shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving agency. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing. Forty-eight or ninety-six 3 ounce (85 g) containers or twelve 1 pound (45 kg) containers of grated cheese shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.2). Five gram pouches of grated cheese shall be packed in accordance with the requirements of PPP-I-350 for mustard for the level specified (see 6.2).

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5.2.1 Level B. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, W5c or W5s, of PPP-B-636. The packages of the grated cheese shall be inclosed in a waterproof case liner, fabricated and closed in accordance with MIL-L-10547 for subsistence items. When the bottom flaps of the shipping container are closed by stitching, the case liner shall be protected from the stitches by placing a paperboard pad between the case liner and the stitches. The case liner shall be protected from stitches in the manufacturer's joint by placing a strip of pressure-sensitive tape over the stitches.

5.2.1.1 When specified (see 6.2 and 6.3), the shipping containers specified in 5.2.1 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level C. The shipping container shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.2.2.1 Civil agencies. Twenty-four 3 ounce (85 g) or twelve 1 pound (.45 kg) cans shall be packed in a container conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The container shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies.

5.3.1.1 Unit containers. Any commercial labeling and additional labeling, as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder is acceptable.

5.3.1.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of FED-STD-123 and such other information, as specified, by individual agencies.

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Unit containers. Labeling as specified in 5.3.1.1 is acceptable.

5.3.2.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Technical information and intended use. The Italian hard cheeses, as represented by the so-called Grana type to which Parmesan (Reggiano) and Romano cheeses belong, are among the more commonly used varieties for grating purposes. Also used as a grated cheese is cheddar cheese, of the proper degree of flavor achieved by controlled ripening or curing, or in a heat processed form such as type IV of this document. The cheese is dried until suitable for grating before final processing is completed. The usual drying procedure involves the simple open tray or belt drier on which the ground or pulverized cheese is layered, as the filled tray is exposed to drying oven temperatures, usually from 110°F - 130° F (43° - 54° C), with circulating filtered, hot air passing over the trays. Drying time is based on the degree of dehydration desired (see 3.4 for moisture requirements). Further grinding of the partially dried cheese may be necessary to reach the fine granule size desired. Keeping quality of the grated cheese is limited to approximately 18 months at 40° F (4° C), 6 months at 70° F (21° C) and 3 months at 90° F (32° C). However, since the product tends to absorb moisture, it is very important that the filled containers remain tightly sealed. Deterioration of flavor in the process of spoilage is often accompanied by a brown or pinkish discoloration. Grated cheese is used as a condiment in cooking and to enhance the flavor of various ethnic dishes, of which spaghetti and lasagna are examples. When class 2 product is specified, the blend of both Parmesan and Romano cheese is based on the degree of blandness or piquancy desired. The greater proportion of Parmesan to Romano cheese, the more the flavor leans toward less piquancy and more to a sweet and nutty-like flavor tone. Commercial packaging of 5, 25, and 100 pounds (2.3 kg, 11.3 kg, and 45.4 kg) are available for large quantity users.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of product required (see 1.2).
(c) Class and proportion limits required for type III (see 1.2 and 3.2.2).
(d) When USDA certificates of quality, quantity and condition are required (see 4.3.2).
(e) Testing for analytical, in-process, and component examinations may be waived on small lot orders (see 4.3.2).
(f) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) Type of level B packaging required (see 5.1.1).
(h) Quantity to be packaged in cans (see 5.1.1.1).
(i) When packing specified in 5.2.1.1 is required.

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6.3 Packing specified in 5.2.1.1 is intended for transfer at sea operations or specific overseas operations.

6.4 Destination inspection (for civil agencies). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at a point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for identity, condition and quantity only.

6.5 Military agencies. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipping, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.14D/DSAR 4145.7.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

VA - DMS
HEW - FDA
AGR - AMS
GSA - FSS

Project No. 8910-0377

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